

This is a photo from Easter dinner in 2005. I'm an advocate for getting together with family and friends as often as possible. It's occasions like these that define your life. I don't recall any elderly person ever saying to me, "I wished I had spent more time in the office."

No matter how hard you work, you must find time for friends and family.

Be the matriarch or patriarch whenever you can, and especially on the topics of love, money and work—those topics many parents seem to avoid. Speak openly and honestly about your own mistakes, ambitions, goals and embarrassments. Humanize yourself. You'll be amazed at how quickly your kids and their cohorts will open up to you—especially if you make your home a happy, warm place where people want to be.

Linda makes a point of keeping our kitchen well stocked with homemade lasagna, spaghetti and meatballs, chicken-fried rice—all the stuff that teenagers love to eat. Trevor and his friends know that food is there for them, and they make good use of it.

If individual family members pass one another like ships in the night, hardly saying two words to each other, let alone sharing a meal, the dynasty breaks down. But families that are successful function more like clans. And make sure every member of your family has their own MBA and has absorbed lifelong lessons about responsibility, integrity and hard work. Long may your dynasty reign.

HOW TO BE AN E.T. (ENTREPRENEUR IN TRAINING)

You don't have to invent a new product or launch a million-dollar start-up to be an E.T. Some of the successful kids I know worked with what they had. Here are three examples of E.T.s who were making money before they could even drive—and I'm proud to say two of them are O'Learys!